

Transformational Leadership: How Dr. Mahendra Sharma is Revolutionizing Higher Education

Transforming education from theoretical to practical, Dr. Mahendra Sharma has positioned Ganpat University as a pioneering institution where industry relevance meets academic rigor, creating a new blueprint for higher education in India

In the competitive landscape of Indian higher education, few leaders have demonstrated the entrepreneurial vision and transformative impact of Dr. Mahendra Sharma, Group Pro Chancellor of Ganpat University in Gujarat. With over 25 years of experience, Dr. Sharma has pioneered an education model that bridges academia and industry—creating what he calls “the symbiotic emergence of academic excellence and industrial relevance.”

Under his stewardship, Ganpat University has evolved from a regional institution to a multidisciplinary powerhouse with innovative centers of excellence across disciplines. “Education must transcend traditional boundaries to remain relevant in today’s rapidly evolving job market,” says Dr. Sharma. “Our focus has always been on creating industry-ready professionals through skill-based learning and corporate collaborations.”

This industry-focused approach has yielded impressive results. The university now boasts partnerships with corporate giants including IBM, SAS, Tata Motors, and TCS, alongside

international academic collaborations spanning four continents. These relationships provide students with global perspectives while maintaining local relevance.

What distinguishes Dr. Sharma’s leadership is his commitment to future-forward education. He has established specialized national centers focused on emerging technologies and sectors—including the National Centre for Additive Manufacturing, National Centre



Dr. Mahendra Sharma
Group Pro Chancellor,
Ganpat University

for Electronics, and centers dedicated to rubber, petrochemicals, sports wellness, and media entertainment.

“The future belongs to specialists who can innovate within their domains while understanding interdisciplinary connections,” Dr. Sharma explains. “We’re building educational ecosystems, not just degree programs.”

His entrepreneurial approach to education has earned recognition across the sector. In 2023-24, The Economic Times named him “Tech Visionary Vice-Chancellor of India,” adding to accolades including SEPC’s “Edupreneur of the Year”, 2024 and the Dewang Mehta National Education Leadership Award.

Beyond campus innovation, Dr. Sharma serves as Chair of ASSOCHAM’s Education Committee for Gujarat and Goa, Co-Chair of their National Education Council, and Advisor to the National Skill Development Corporation. His leadership extends internationally through GUNI Education Services in the UAE and directorship of several educational foundations.

The impact of this work extends beyond institutional growth. “Our student-first approach focuses on enhancing the complete persona through rigorous knowledge transfer and practical training,” notes Dr. Sharma. “Success in education isn’t measured by enrollment numbers but by graduate outcomes and societal contribution.”

As India positions itself as a global knowledge hub, leaders like Dr. Sharma demonstrate how educational institutions can balance traditional academic values with entrepreneurial vision—creating frameworks for innovation that prepare students for an increasingly competitive global marketplace while contributing to national development priorities.